

Cell Death Training App

Aneequa Sundus

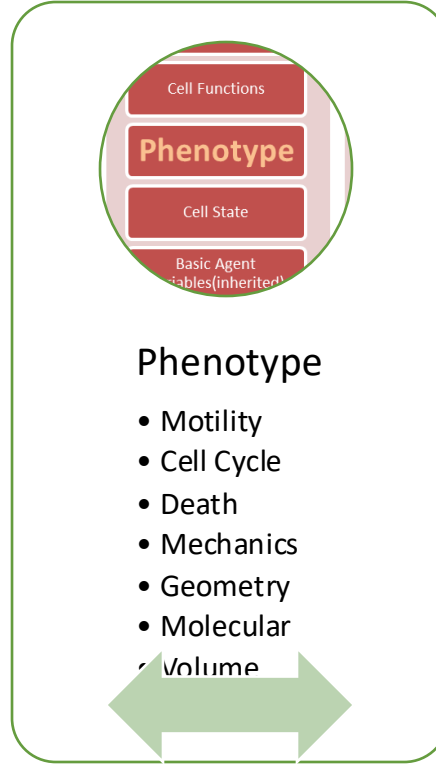


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Context



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Context

Microenvironment

Domain Size

Voxel Size

Substrates

Boundary Conditions

Cells

Custom Data

Cell Functions

Phenotype

Cell State

Basic Agent
Variables(inherited)

Cell Definition

Global Variables

User Parameters

PhysiCell Constants

List of cells

SVG options

MultiCellIDS options

Default Cell Definition

Default microenvironment



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A note about time steps

- PhysiCell is designed to account for the multiple time scales inherent to these problems, and has 3 time scales:

▪ $\Delta t_{\text{diffusion}}$	diffusion, secretion, and uptake	(default: 0.01 min)
▪ $\Delta t_{\text{mechanics}}$	cell movement	(default: 0.1 min)
▪ Δt_{cell}	phenotype and volume changes	(default: 6 min)
- This allows some efficiency improvements: not all functions need to be evaluated at each time step.
- See the PhysiCell method paper. (Oddly, not in the User Guide (yet).)



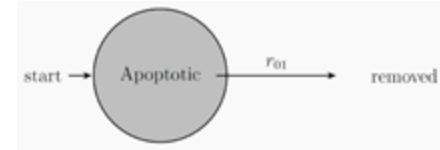
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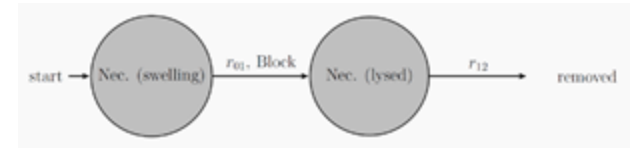
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Phenotype: Death

- **Death** has one or more death models:
 - ✦ A specialized cycle model with a *removal* transition rate
 - ✦ Extra parameters to help govern cell volume
 - ✦ Each death model has an associated death rate
 - ✦ Also stores an easy Boolean **dead** to easily check if the cell is alive.
- PhysiCell has built-in apoptosis and necrosis death models



Apoptosis



Necrosis

Documentation: User Guide, Sec. 11.2



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Cell definition: death

```
<death>
  <model code="100" name="apoptosis">
    <death_rate units="1/min">0</death_rate>
    <!-- use phase_transition_rates OR phase_durations -->
    <phase_durations units="min">
      <duration index="0" fixed_duration="true">516</duration>
    </phase_durations>
    <parameters>
      <unlysed_fluid_change_rate units="1/min">0.05</unlysed_fluid_change_rate>
      <lysed_fluid_change_rate units="1/min">0</lysed_fluid_change_rate>
      <cytoplasmic_biomass_change_rate units="1/min">1.66667e-02</cytoplasmic_biomass_change_rate>
      <nuclear_biomass_change_rate units="1/min">5.83333e-03</nuclear_biomass_change_rate>
      <calcification_rate units="1/min">0</calcification_rate>
      <relative_rupture_volume units="dimensionless">2.0</relative_rupture_volume>
    </parameters>
  </model>
  <model code="101" name="necrosis">
    <death_rate units="1/min">0.0</death_rate>
    <!-- necrosis uses phase_duration[0] = 0 so that it always immediately
         tries to transition and instead checks volume against the rupture volume -->
    <phase_durations units="min">
      <duration index="0" fixed_duration="true">0</duration>
      <duration index="1" fixed_duration="true">86400</duration>
    </phase_durations>
    <parameters>
      <unlysed_fluid_change_rate units="1/min">0.05</unlysed_fluid_change_rate>
      <lysed_fluid_change_rate units="1/min">0</lysed_fluid_change_rate>
      <cytoplasmic_biomass_change_rate units="1/min">1.66667e-02</cytoplasmic_biomass_change_rate>
      <nuclear_biomass_change_rate units="1/min">5.83333e-03</nuclear_biomass_change_rate>
      <calcification_rate units="1/min">0</calcification_rate>
      <relative_rupture_volume units="dimensionless">2.0</relative_rupture_volume>
    </parameters>
  </model>
</death>
```

- Use `death_rate` to determine the rate of *starting* each mode of death.
- Use the `phase_durations` and parameters to control how cells progress through each death model.



Credits

Lesson Planning: Paul Macklin

Slides: Aneequa Sundus, Kali Konstantinopoulos*, Mary Chen*, Furkan Kurtoglu

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- National Cancer Institute (U01CA232137)
- National Science Foundation (1720625)

Training materials:

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